AXA · Batch 2 Operations · Day 1

Power Automate for Everyday Operations

19 October 2026

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Today: Four Practical Sections

Each section ends with something you can show and check.

1

Foundations and manual email

Identify triggers and actions · Build an email flow · Verify two runs

2

Request intake and routing

Collect requests · Record them in Excel · Test both category routes

3

Approval and one reminder

Complete an approval · Record the decision · Verify one reminder

4

Generative AI as your flow assistant

Review a screenshot · Verify advice · Repair and test

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SECTION 1

Foundations and Manual Email

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A Simple Morning Routine

A trigger starts work; an action does work; checking confirms the result.

Trigger
Alarm rings

Action
Pack work bag

Check result
Phone and keys are inside

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A Condition Adds Another Path

A Condition chooses a path from a Yes or No answer.

Trigger
Alarm rings

Are you sleepy?

No

Action
Pack work bag

Check result
Phone and keys

Yes

Action
Drink coffee

ASK **Which path runs when the answer is Yes?**

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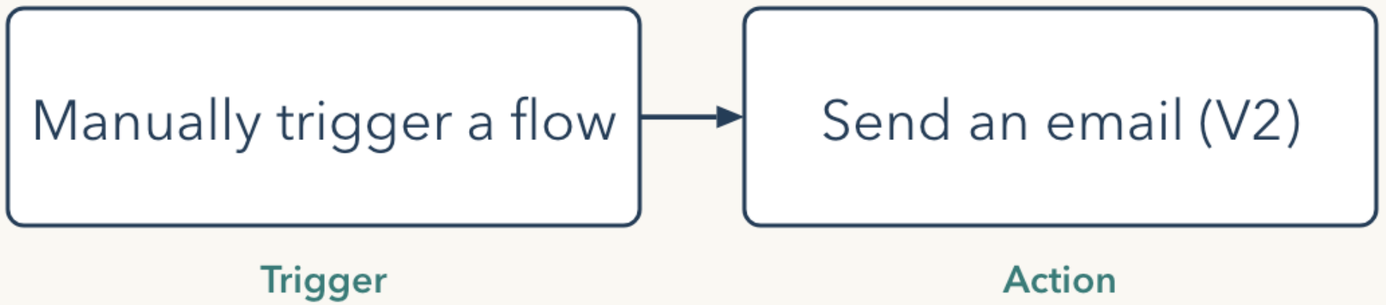
The Same Idea in Exercise 1

Build two configured steps, then check the run and received email.

CONFIGURED FLOW



CHECK RESULT

Verification activity

1. Inspect Run history
2. Confirm the email contains TaskTitle

Build the two steps. Then inspect the evidence.

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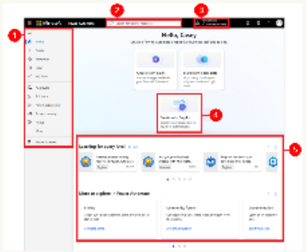
Your Practice Workspace

Use your training account in all four apps.

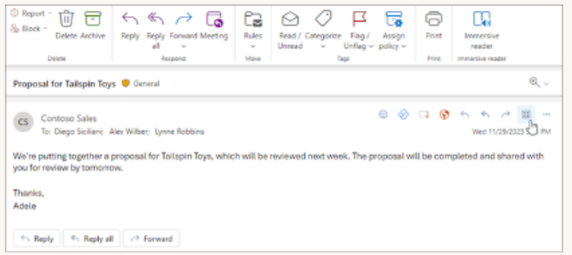
Power Automate

Build flows



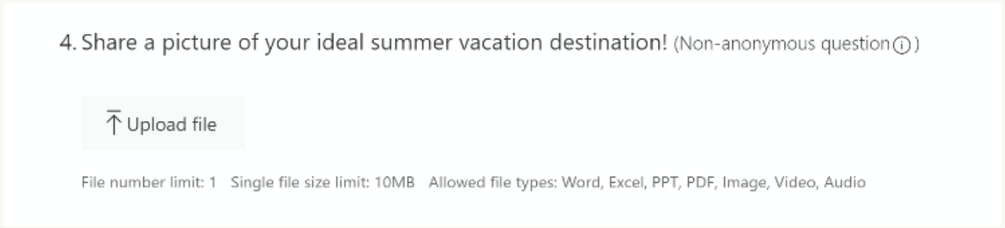
Outlook

Check emails



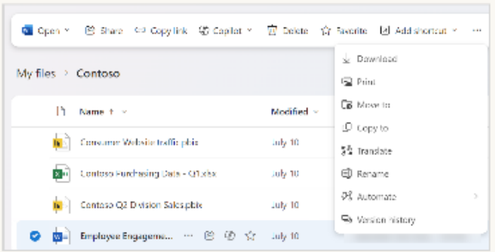
Microsoft Forms

Collect requests



OneDrive for Business

Store workbooks



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Environment

An environment is the space containing the flows and resources you are permitted to use.

Like the designated room for the operations desk.

Environment

Practice flow

Connection account

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Trigger

A trigger starts a cloud flow.

Like the office doorbell that signals a new arrival.

Examples

Manually trigger a flow: a person starts the run.
When a new response is submitted: a Form response starts the run.

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Action

An action performs a configured step after the trigger.

Like one step on the operations desk checklist.

Send an email (V2) sends the configured message.

Add a row into a table writes a record.

Each action needs the right inputs.

Manually trigger a flow → Send an email (V2)

CHECK Which action produces the email in our first exercise?

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Connector and Connection

The connector identifies the service; the connection provides the authorised access used by the flow.

Term	Everyday analogy	Our example
Connector	A service entrance	Office 365 Outlook
Connection	The identity permitted through it	Your authorised training account

CHECK Which connector and connected account will send your email?

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Cloud Flow Types

Choose the flow type according to how the work starts.

Type	Starting point	Example
Instant	A person starts it	Our manual email
Automated	An event occurs	Our Forms request
Scheduled	A configured schedule	A reminder pattern

CHECK Which type fits a newly submitted Form response?

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Trigger Inputs

A trigger input supplies a value when a person runs the manual flow.

Input name: TaskTitle

Input type: Text

The same input name can receive a different value on another run.

Example value

Prepare the weekly work summary

CHECK Which is the input name, and which is the value entered for a run?

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Dynamic Content

A dynamic token inserts a value produced by an earlier step.

Like filling a reusable letter from a task slip.

Select TaskTitle from the manual trigger.

Subject	Training task: **TaskTitle**
Body	New training task: **TaskTitle**

Inserted token: TaskTitle — Manually trigger a flow

CHECK How would you tell a typed word from a dynamic token?

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Anatomy of an email action

An action needs values to do its work.

Send an email (V2) — Office 365 Outlook

To	Your own training email
Subject	Training task: **TaskTitle**
Body	New training task: **TaskTitle**

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Execution and results

Check what ran and what arrived.

Conceptual example

Run record

Inputs

TaskTitle: Weekly summary

Action status **Succeeded**

Received email

Training task: Weekly summary

New training task: Weekly summary

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SECTION 2

Request Intake and Routing

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Forms gives requests a structure

Consistent questions produce usable answers.

Loose request

Please organise the weekly summary.

Structured request

Task title

Weekly summary

Text · Required

Category Operations

Choice · Required

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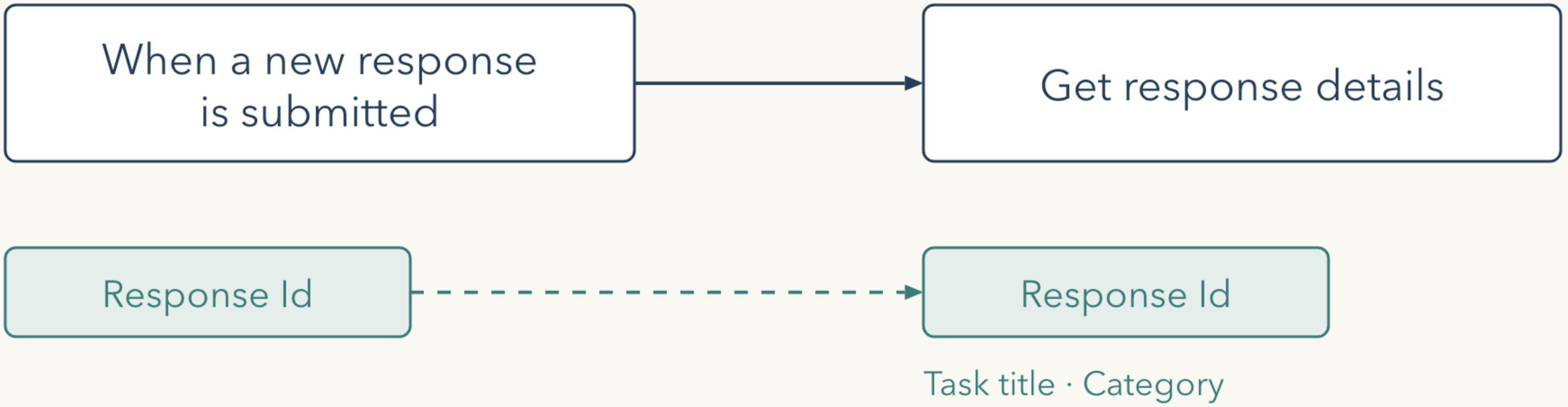
Notification and response details

The trigger announces; the action retrieves.

Microsoft Forms



Solid: execution · Dashed: data mapping

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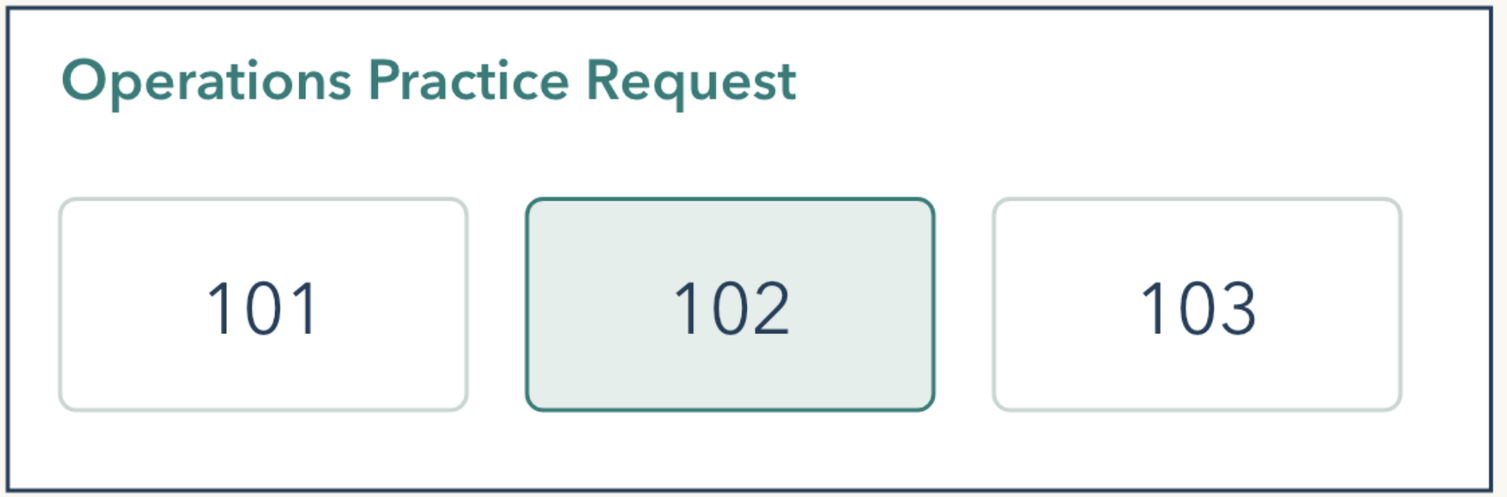
Form Id and Response Id

Identify the form, then identify its submission.

Form Id

Which form?



Response Id

Which response?

Get response details

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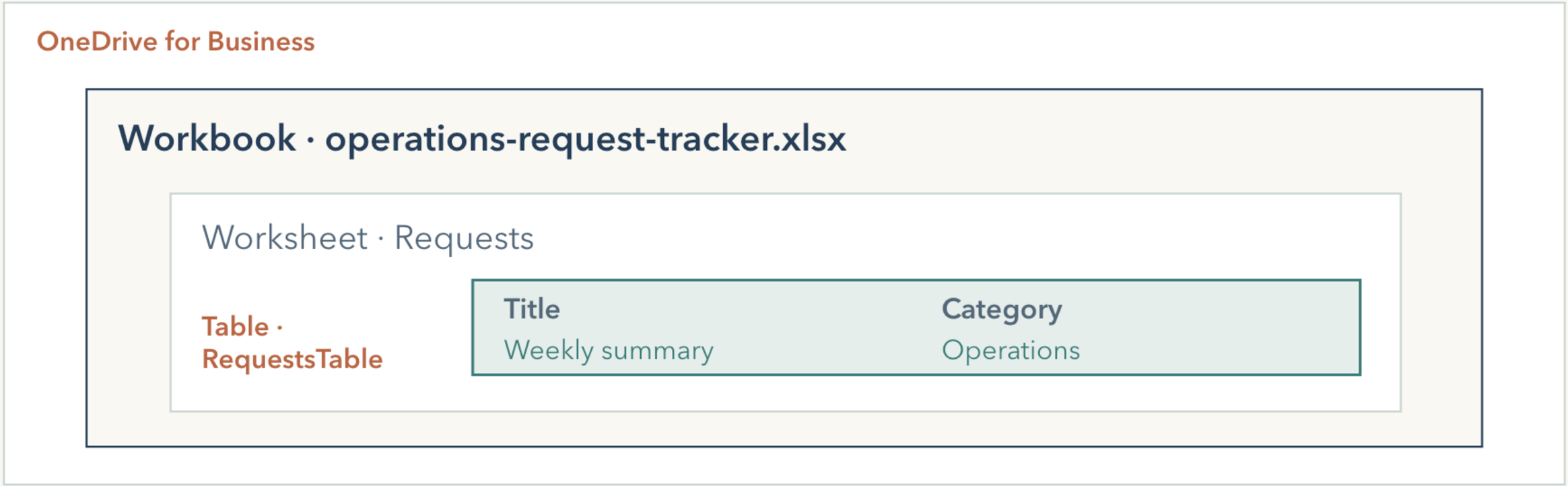
Workbook, worksheet and Table

The Excel action targets a named Table.



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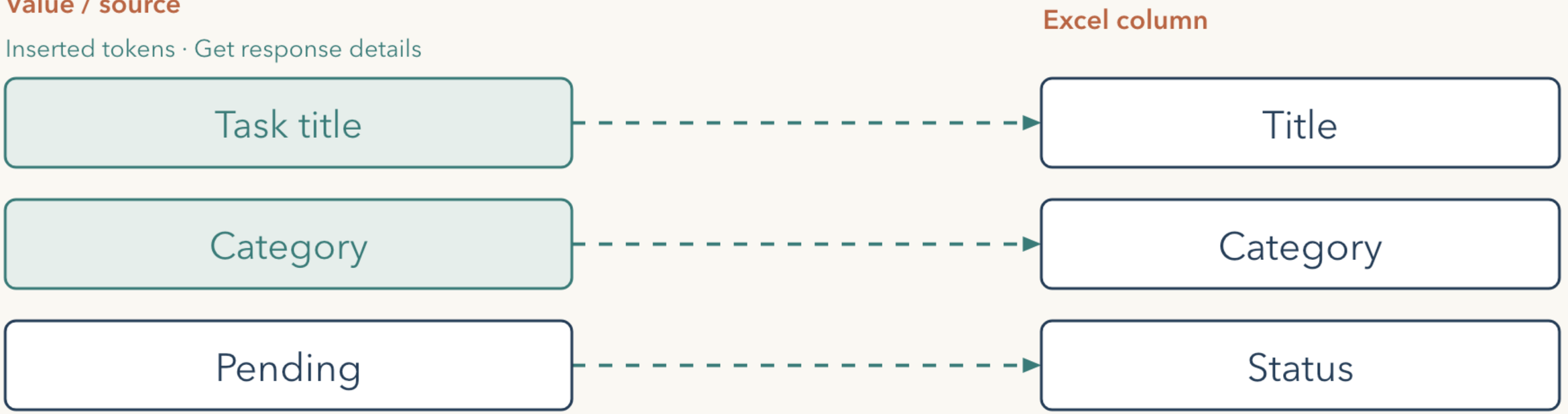
Add a row into a table

One request becomes one record.

Excel Online (Business)



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Anatomy of a Condition

A comparison produces True or False.

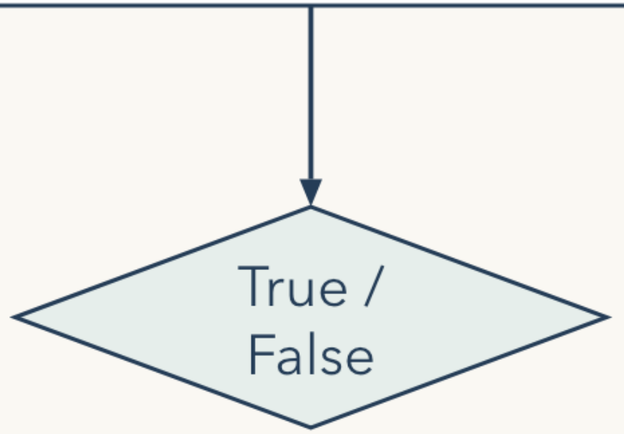
Value

Category

Token · Get response details

Operator

is equal to



Comparison value

Operations

Typed text

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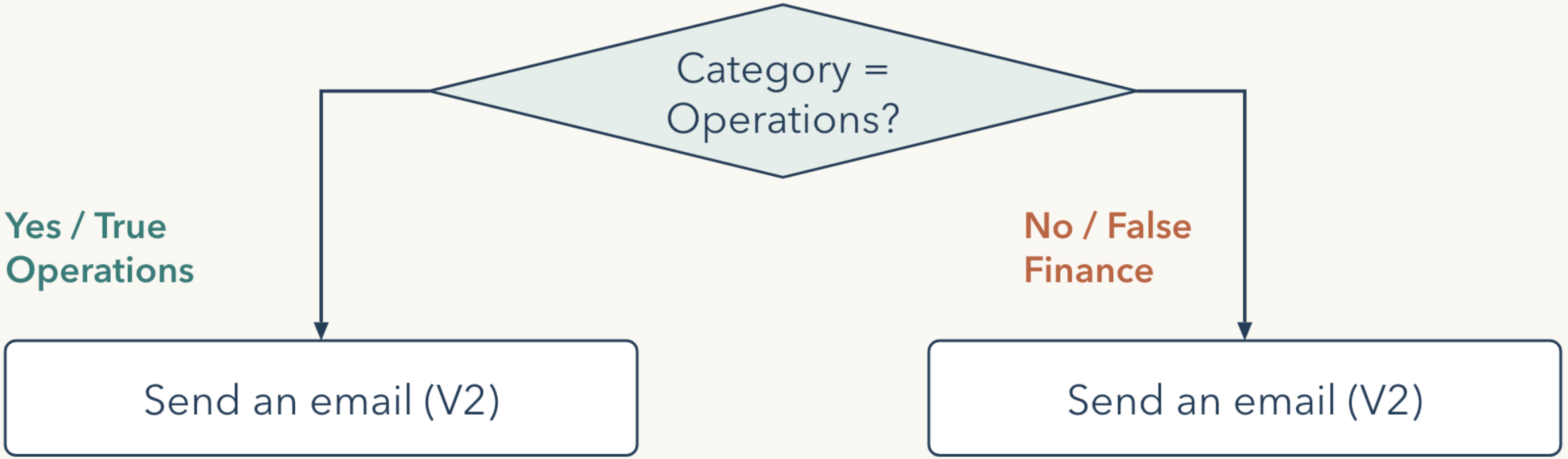
A Condition chooses a route

One result selects one branch.



Training: both routes use your mailbox

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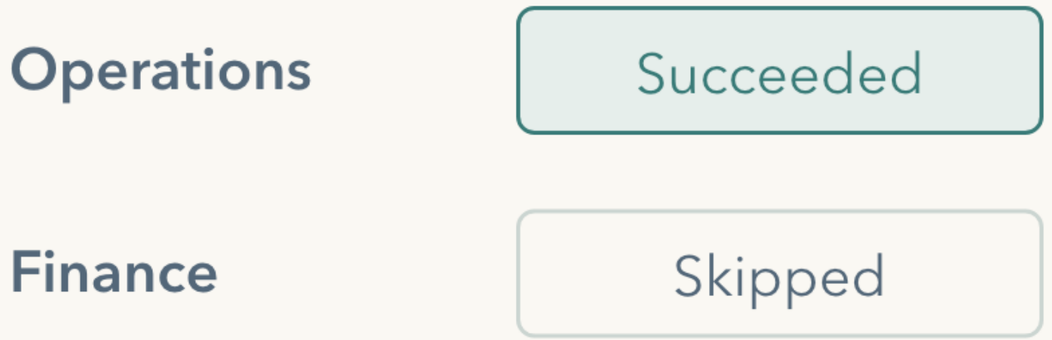
Skipped can be expected

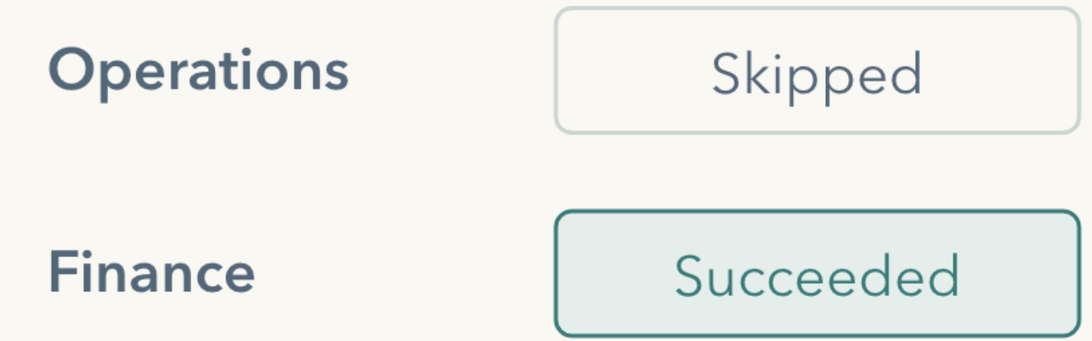
The unselected branch does not run.

Conceptual run examples

Category: Operations



Category: Finance



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SECTION 3

Approval and One Reminder

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Human decision and automatic rule

An approval asks a person; a Condition evaluates a rule.

Approval

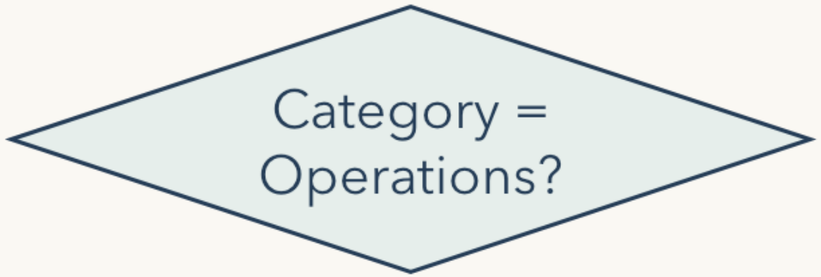
Judgement

Complete checklist · Approve

Missing owner · Reject

Condition

Comparison



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Anatomy of an approval request

Give the reviewer a clear decision to make.

Title	Request title
Assigned to	Your own training email
Details	Review brief and decision context

Approve Reject

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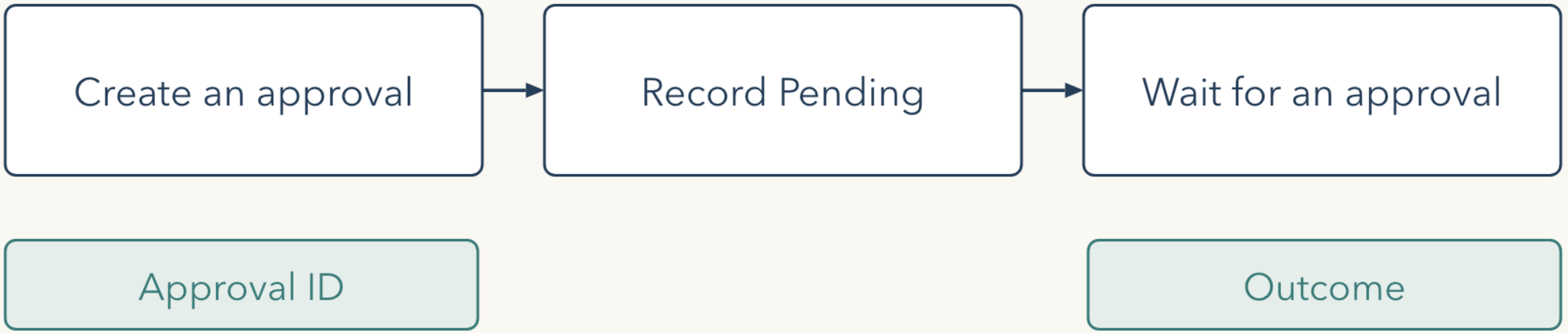
Create and wait are different actions

Create issues the request; Wait receives its decision.

Approvals



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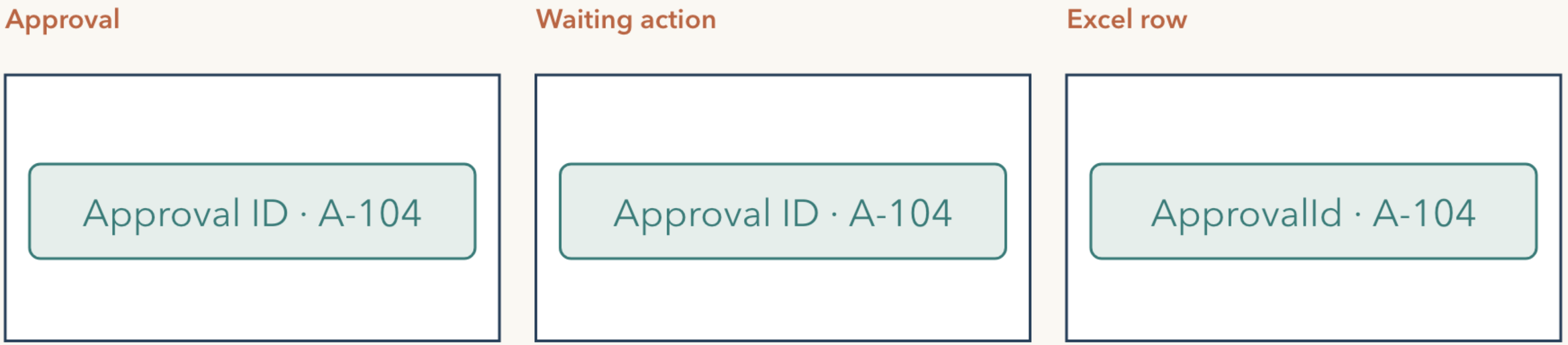
One approval, one identity

Approval ID links everything to the same request.



Request title · Handover checklist

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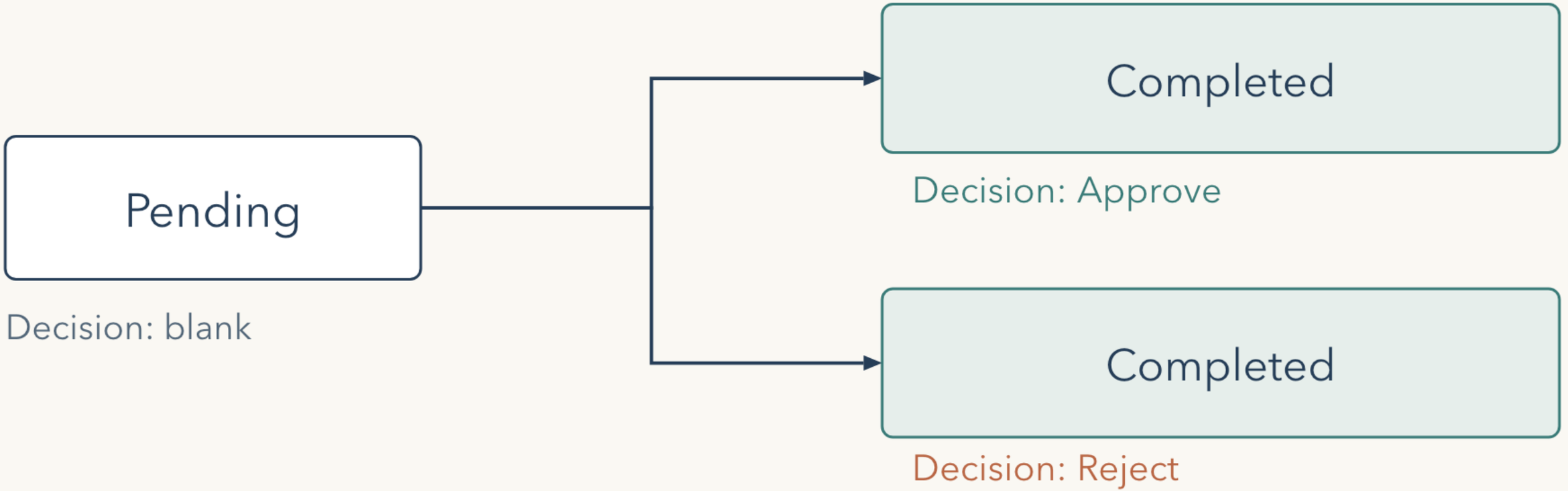
Status and decision answer different questions

Completed means a response was recorded.

Tracker values



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Update the matching row

Find the record by its key, then change its values.

Key Column ApprovalId

Key Value A-104

ApprovalId	Status	Decision
A-103	Completed	Approve
A-104	Pending	–
A-105	Pending	–

Update a row

A-104
Completed
Outcome → Decision

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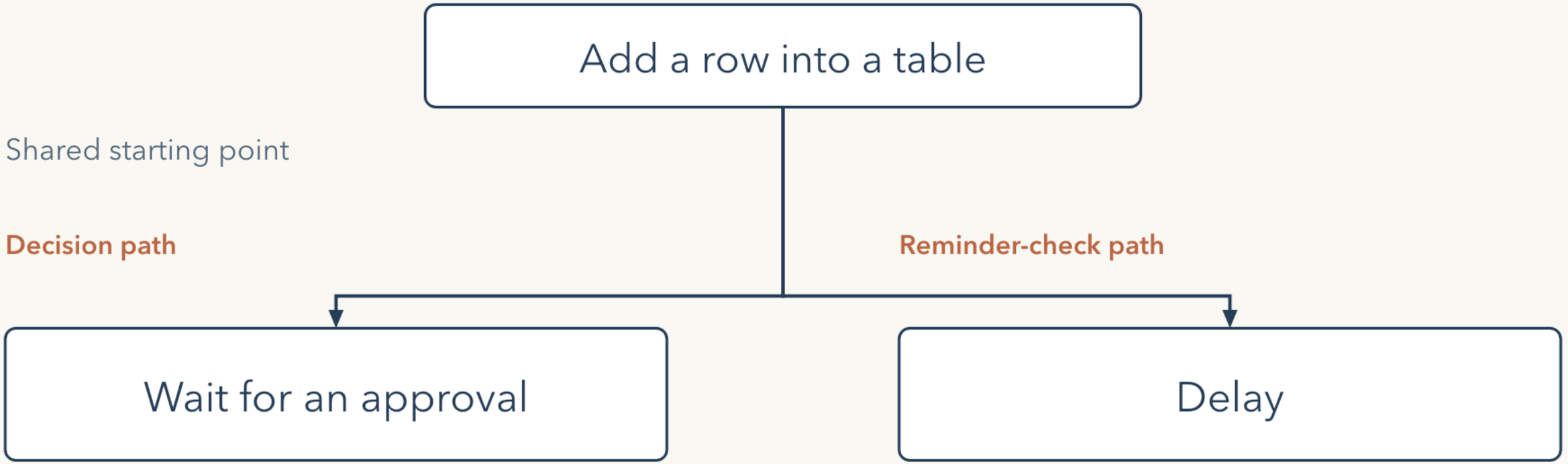
Parallel branches

Two paths can progress independently.



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Waiting for time or waiting for a person

Delay waits for time; approval waiting depends on a response.

Delay

Count + Unit

Time passes

Wait for an approval

Approval ID

Reviewer responds

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Get a row reads the stored record

Look up the same request again.

Earlier snapshot

ApprovalId: A-104

Status: Pending

Get a row

Key Column: ApprovalId

Key Value: Approval ID

Current stored Status

Pending or Completed

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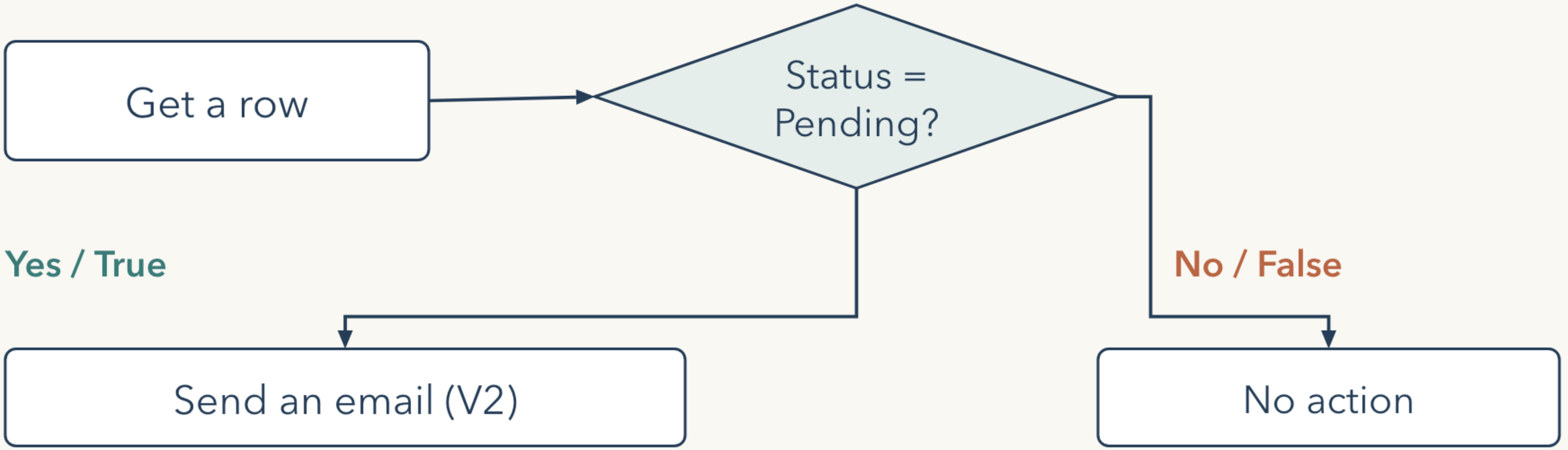
The reminder decision

Remind when the retrieved status is Pending.

Original Approval ID



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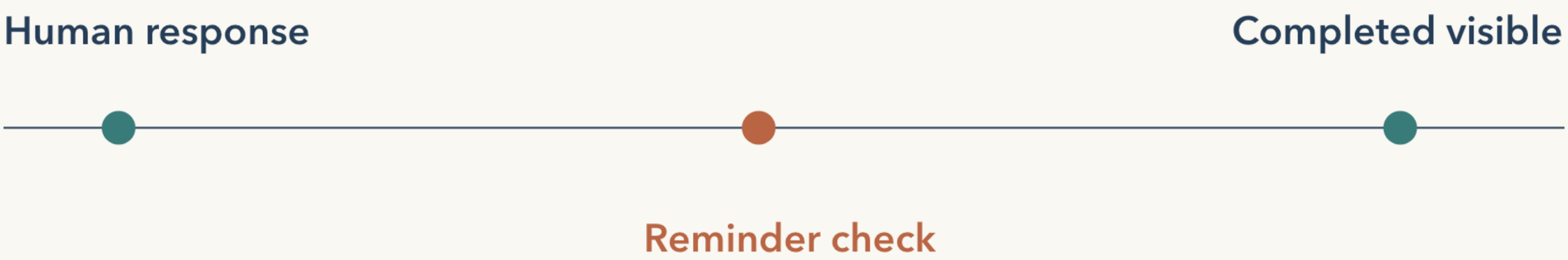
Stored status can lag

A tracker may update after the person responds.



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SECTION 4

Generative AI as Your Flow Assistant

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AI as a technical reviewer

AI can explain and suggest; you decide and verify.

Explain

Question

Suggest

Human judgement

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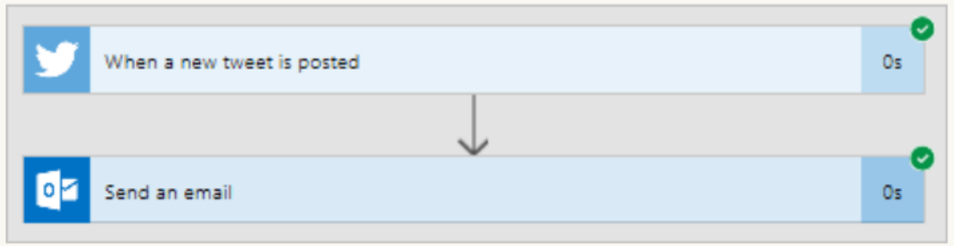
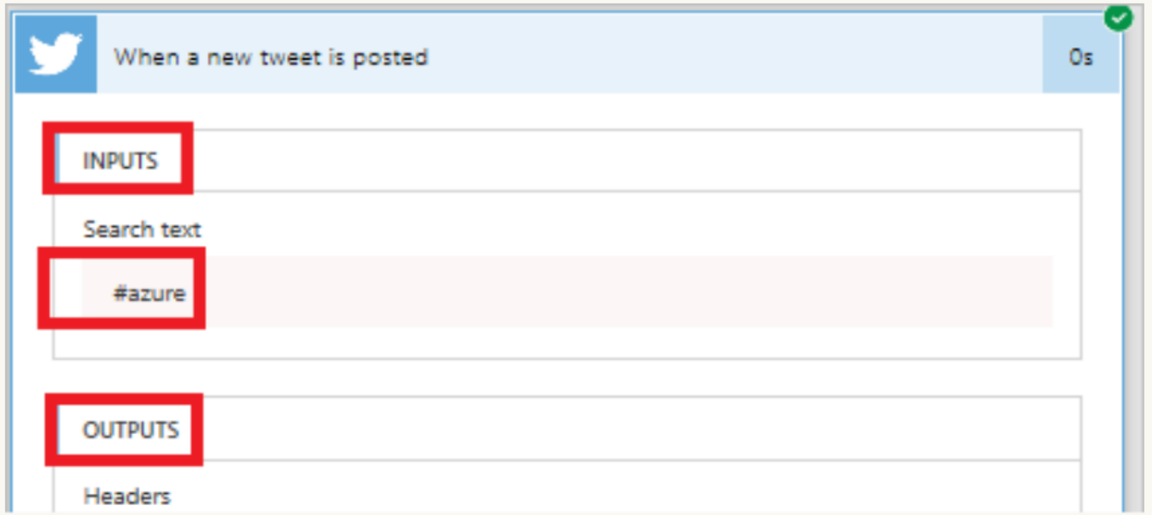
A screenshot shows only what is visible

Hidden settings require more evidence.

Overview



Close-up



Sequence and status

Missing context

Inputs and outputs

Different flow · same visibility limit

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Give the AI a role and a task

A useful prompt defines how the assistant should help.

Role	Act as a Power Automate coach.
Evidence	Review this screenshot.
Task	Suggest one correction.
Verify	Check Microsoft Learn.
Test	Give a test.

Open complete starter

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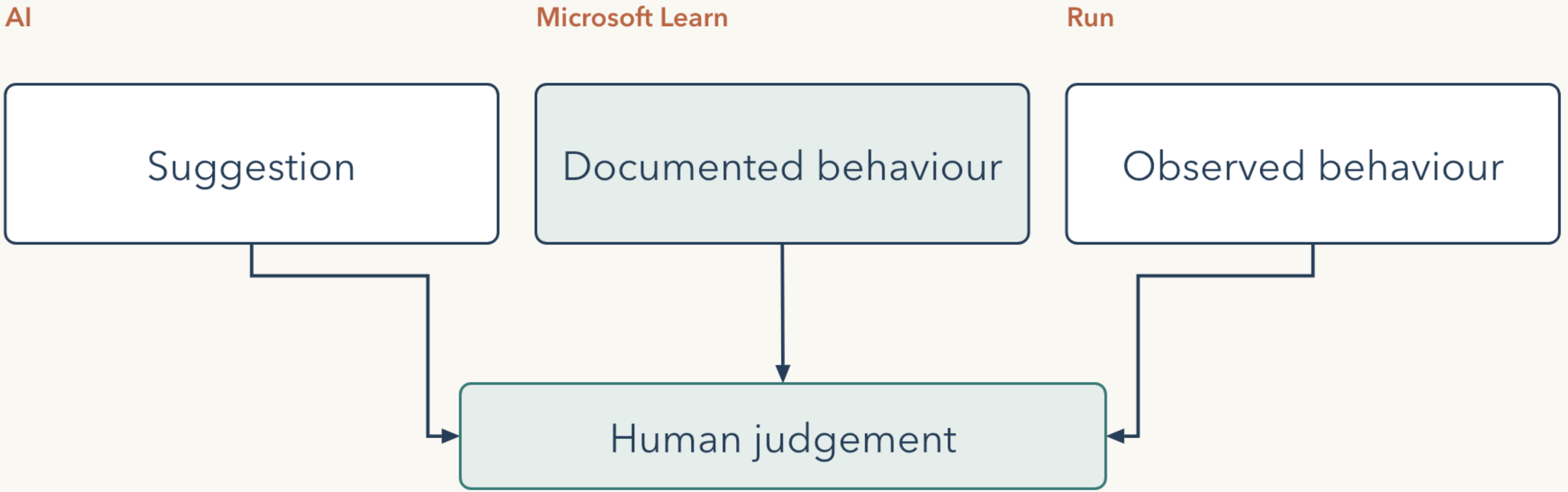
Advice, documentation and execution

Each provides a different kind of evidence.



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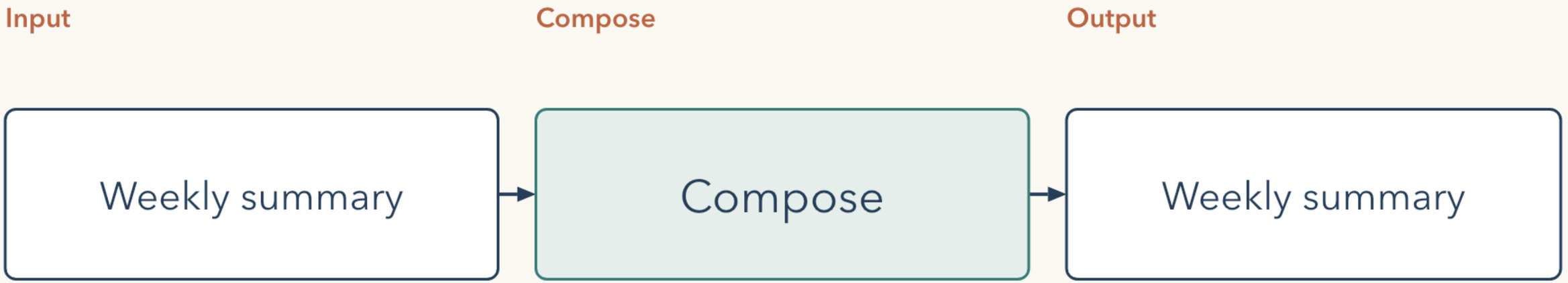
Compose makes a value inspectable

Compose produces an output from its input.



Text or expression

Built-in · Data Operation

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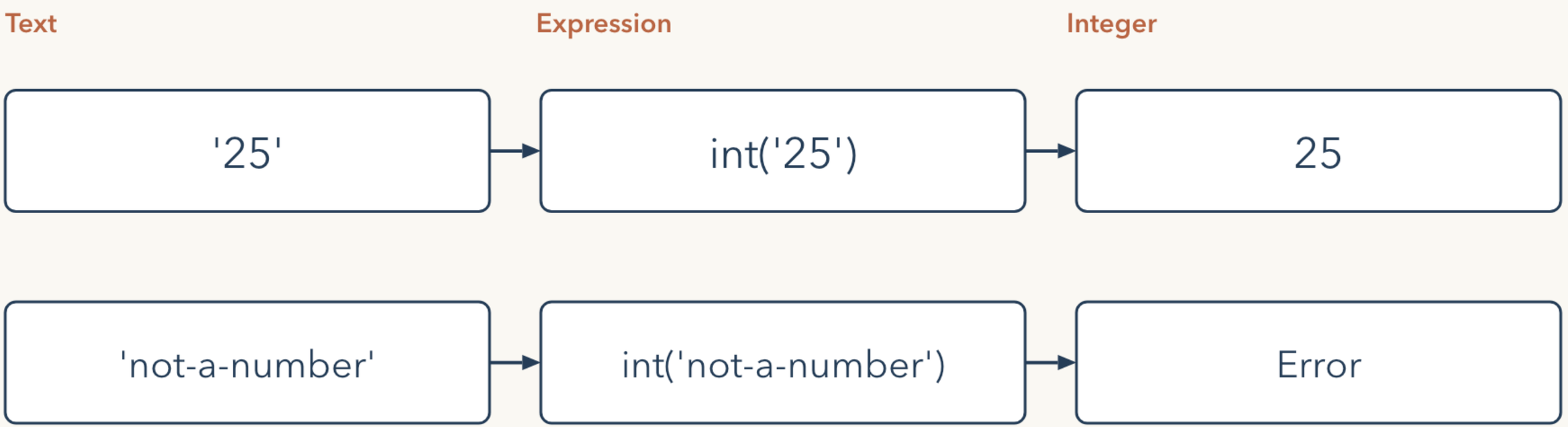
Text and numbers are different types

Conversion needs a value the function understands.



Conceptual examples

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Where did the error happen?

Save-time errors and run-time failures leave different evidence.

Save validation

Invalid constant may be rejected

Failed run

Actual dynamic value fails

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Read the error in context

The message needs its action, expression and input.

Conceptual evidence panel

Action	Compose · conversion
Actual input	not-a-number
Expression	int(outputs('SampleText'))
Error message	Integer conversion failed

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A repair needs fresh evidence

A changed expression is a proposal until tested.

Conceptual comparison

Before

```
int('not-a-number')
```

Smallest change

```
int('25')
```

Expected output

Integer 25

Observed output

Compare with the new run

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The building blocks of a useful flow

Connect a clear event to useful work and observable results.

Trigger

Data

Action

Decision

Record

Evidence

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